

Fast Ethernet

Also known as 100BaseT, Fast Ethernet is an upgraded standard for connecting computers in a LAN. Fast Ethernet works just like regular Ethernet (also known as 10BaseT), except that it can transfer data at a maximum rate of 100 Mbps instead of 10 Mbps.

FHSS

Frequency Hopping Spread Spectrum. A type of spread spectrum radio technology where the sender and receiver ‘hop’ together from one frequency to another to avoid detection or jamming.

Firewall

A system that prevents unauthorised users from logging in to a private network, usually one that’s connected to the Internet. It can also be used to keep users inside the firewall from accessing computers outside the firewall. A firewall could be a dedicated computer equipped with security measures such as a dial-back feature, a software-based protection, or a combination of both. The firewall screens incoming server requests to make sure they come from authorised sources.

Fragment

In networking, a packet whose size exceeds the bandwidth of the network is broken into smaller pieces called fragments.

Fragmentation Length

In a network, the maximum size or length of a fragment is determined by the protocol used to transport the data.

FTP

File Transfer Protocol. This protocol is used to copy files between computers, usually between a client and an archive site. It’s a bit on the slow side, doesn’t support compression, and uses cryptic Unix command parameters. But you can download shareware or freeware applications that shield you from the complexities of Unix, and you can also connect to FTP sites using a Web browser.